Paid to Onboarded

Set up what happens automatically after someone pays, plus the welcome, delivery and check-in messages you send yourself.

BUILDER | 60 MIN | PLAYBOOK: FIRST LAUNCH CHECKLIST | PLAYBOOK: THE SIMPLE OPERATIONS STACK

WHEN THIS HAPPENS	THIS HAPPENS
A customer pays you	They see what happens next, get a receipt, and you get an alert, then you welcome, deliver and check in on a set schedule

TOOLS	COST	SETUP	CHECKED
Stripe, Square, PayPal, Shopify	Fees vary by processor and plan. Check current pricing before you launch.	about 45 min	2026-10

YOU WALK AWAY WITH

A tested payment link with a custom confirmation, automatic receipts and alerts, and ready messages from welcome to testimonial ask.

USE IT

Use it the week before you launch, after your payment account is set up and before your first real customer pays.

The moment after someone pays is when trust is highest and doubt starts. A clear next step keeps it high.

This recipe sets up the automatic part once. Then it gives you the messages for the human part, so every customer gets the same careful first week.

What this does

Someone pays. Automatically, they see a confirmation with next steps, they get a receipt and you get an alert. Then you take over: welcome, deliver, check in and ask three questions.

Before you start

- [ ] Your offer and price are written in your One-Page Offer.
- [ ] Your delivery steps are written down, from payment to finished work.
- [ ] Your payment account is set up and verified. The Before You Take Money checklist covers this, plus taxes and local rules.
- [ ] Your Pipeline Tracker is open. Paying customers go in the Won stage.
- [ ] Your own card is ready for a test payment you'll refund.

> Under 18? Payment processors usually require an adult account holder. Stripe lets you open an account at 13. But if you're under 18, a legal guardian must take the owner role before you can accept payments. Check the processor's terms; a parent or guardian may need to open the account.

Set it up. Stripe Payment Link for services.

1. In the Stripe Dashboard, create a payment link for your product and price.
2. In Options, collect only what delivery needs. Turn on Require customers to provide a phone number if you'll text them. Turn on Collect customer addresses if you go to them or ship.
3. Use Add custom fields for one delivery question, like the target job title or the gym's Instagram handle. Never ask for sensitive information.
4. Open the After the payment tab. Under Confirmation page, replace the default message with yours (copy below). Or redirect to a thank-you page on your site.
5. Turn on automatic email receipts in your Stripe settings.
6. Update your notification preferences so you get an email for every successful payment.
7. Pay the link with your own card, check everything, then refund it from the payment in your dashboard.

CONFIRMATION PAGE MESSAGE COPY

```
You're in. Thank you for trusting me with [service].

What happens next:
1. I'll message you within [timeframe] at the email or phone you just gave me.
2. [Next step, e.g. we pick a time for your first session.]
3. [When they get the result, e.g. your edited resume within 48 hours of our call.]

Questions before then? Reach me at [email or phone].
```

Square or PayPal instead

Square and PayPal also offer payment links. Look for the same three things: a custom confirmation message or redirect, an automatic receipt, and an alert to you when someone pays. Then test with a real payment and refund it.

Selling products on Shopify

Shopify can email customers an order confirmation automatically. To edit it, go to Settings, then Notifications, and open Order confirmation. Make it sound like you. Say when the order ships and how to reach you. Place a test order, then refund or cancel it.

Your after-payment timeline

When	What happens	Who does it
Seconds after paying	Confirmation with next steps	Automatic
Minutes after	Receipt to them, payment alert to you	Automatic
Within 24 hours	Welcome message, logged as Won in your Pipeline Tracker	You
Delivery day	The work, plus your delivery message	You

When	What happens	Who does it
2 to 3 days after delivery	Check-in with three questions	You
After a happy answer	Testimonial ask, with permission	You

Welcome them (within 24 hours)

WELCOME MESSAGE (SEND IT YOURSELF) COPY

```
Hey [name], it's [your name]. Thank you for booking [service]. Here's the plan:
- [Step 1, e.g. Saturday at 10am I pick up the shoes.]
- [Step 2, e.g. Sunday I send a progress photo.]
- [Step 3, e.g. They're back to you by Tuesday.]

To get started, I just need [one thing, e.g. your shoe size and the stain you care about most]. Any questions, reply here.
```

Deliver

1. Follow your written delivery steps every time. Same order, same quality.
2. If the work takes more than a day, send one progress update in the middle.
3. Deliver on or before the promised date. If you'll be late, say so before the deadline, not after.

DELIVERY MESSAGE COPY

```
Done. Here's your [deliverable or a photo of the finished work]: [link or photo]. [One line on how to use it or care for it.] I'll check in on [day] to see how it's going.
```

Check in (2 to 3 days after delivery)

CHECK-IN WITH THE THREE QUESTIONS COPY

```
Hey [name], how's [result] holding up? Three quick questions if you have a minute:
1. What almost stopped you from buying?
2. What was the best part?
3. What would you change?
Honest answers help me make it better.
```

Log every answer. Answers to the first question go straight into your Objection Log.

Ask for a testimonial, with permission

TESTIMONIAL ASK COPY

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Thank you, [name]. That means a lot. Could I share what you said on my page? I'd use: "[their exact words]" with [first name and last initial / no name]. Totally fine to say no or change the wording.
```

Only post words they approved, exactly as approved. Never write a review for them, change their meaning or pay for a good one.

> “How you do one thing is how people perceive you do most things.”
>
> ELI

Test it

- [ ] Pay your own link from your phone.
- [ ] The confirmation message shows and the next steps make sense.
- [ ] The receipt arrives in your inbox.
- [ ] You get the payment alert.
- [ ] Every field you asked for shows on the payment in your dashboard.
- [ ] You refund the test payment.
- [ ] A friend reads your welcome, delivery and check-in messages and tells you what's unclear.

Keep it human

Automate the repeat, never the relationship. The tools confirm the payment. You send the welcome, do the work, ask the questions and say thank you yourself.

If it breaks

- No receipt arrived: check automatic receipts are on, then check spam.
- No payment alert: update your notification settings to email you for every payment.
- The customer missed the next steps: your welcome message covers it. Send it today.
- You're missing a delivery detail: add one custom field to the link, or ask for it in your welcome.
- Someone wants a refund: keep the promise you made. Refund it, then ask what went wrong.

Next step

Put your first three answers to What almost stopped you from buying? in your Objection Log. Then fix your offer for the top one.

Make today day one.

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